

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 941

By Pody

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor Michael Patrick Leahy.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize those individuals whose professional achievements and civic engagement contribute to the public discourse and the civic life of our State and nation; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy individual is Michael Patrick Leahy, a respected journalist, author, and radio host, who has distinguished himself through many years of dedication to journalism and civic education; and

WHEREAS, for the past fifteen years, Mr. Leahy has been a Tennessee-based journalist, first serving as a reporter for Breitbart News before expanding his work in the field of independent journalism; and

WHEREAS, nine years ago he founded *The Tennessee Star*, a Nashville-based news organization through which he continues to serve as Chief Executive Officer and Editor-in-Chief, providing news coverage and commentary on matters of public interest to the citizens of this State; and

WHEREAS, in 2025, Mr. Leahy and his colleagues at *The Tennessee Star* were honored with the Dao Prize for best local journalism in the country, a recognition that highlights the impact of their work in the field of local reporting; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his work as a journalist, Michael Patrick Leahy has served for eight years as a radio show host in Nashville, engaging listeners in discussions on public affairs and civic issues; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Leahy is also an author who has contributed to civic education through his work *Guide to the Constitution and Bill of Rights for Secondary School Students*, a book he

coauthored to help young people better understand the principles of American government and constitutional liberty; and

WHEREAS, inspired by this work, in 2017 he founded the National Constitution Bee, an annual scholarship competition designed to encourage high school students to deepen their knowledge of the United States Constitution and the Bill of Rights; and

WHEREAS, in October 2026, Mr. Leahy will serve as master of ceremonies for the National Constitution Bee to be held in Brentwood, continuing his commitment to promoting civic literacy and constitutional education among the next generation of Americans; and

WHEREAS, through his work as a journalist, broadcaster, author, and civic educator, Michael Patrick Leahy has contributed to the ongoing conversation about public affairs and constitutional principles, and it is fitting that we recognize his efforts and accomplishments; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor Michael Patrick Leahy for his contributions to journalism, civic education, and public discourse in the State of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.